

Roads and Bridges:

The present state government has given top priority to construction of roads and bridges as part of infrastructure development. In comparison to the year 2002-03, six time more funds have been spent in the year 2007-08 under these heads. During the year 2002-03 Rs 225.19 crore from Plan head (general), Rs 45.71 crore from Tribal Sub-Plan and Rs 17.64 crore from Scheduled Tribe Area Development Scheme head was spent on the construction of roads and bridges while during the financial year 2007-08, this expenditure was to the tune of Rs 1194.87 crore from Plan head (general), Rs 377.57 from Tribal Sub-Plan and Rs 294.07 from Scheduled Tribe Area Development Scheme.

- For roads and bridges six times more funds spent in year 2007-08 in comparison to year 2002-03.
- 40 thousands km road length constructed and upgraded over four and half years.
- 4215 roads constructed under PMGSY, connecting 7489 villages.

In the year 1996-97 only Rs 53.63 crore was received under the above three heads out of which Rs 49.72 crore was spent on construction of roads and bridges.

Since 2003, road development projects are firmly in place. A sum of Rs. 4760 crore has been spent on construction of 4215 roads with a length of 20,34 km under Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana. Besides, a sum of Rs. 4842 crore has been spent on construction of 16911 km roads under various schemes of the state government from 2003 to 2007. A total of 40 thousand km road length has been constructed and upgraded during last four and half years. Under Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana, Rs 1535 crore has been spent on developing 16089 km of roads benefiting 3816 villages. In the budget of 2007-08 a provision of Rs 1996 crore was made for construction of roads: This was 50 percent more than the previous budget. The provision for road construction in the budget of 2008-09 is to the tune of Rs 2269 crore.

MP is the first state in the country where the government of India has sanctioned five road projects costing Rs 1022 crore 52 lakh under Viability Gap Funding. These roads are Chandrapur-Barwani, Matkuli-Chhindwara, Mandsaur-Sitamaui (up to Rajasthan border), Bhopal-Dewas and Jawar-Nayagaon. A target has been fixed to complete 19 more road projects important for development and tourism activities. About seven thousand kilometer length of roads is being improved under State Road Improvement Programme at a cost of Rs 500 crore. The state government has also decided to connect 2574 villages situated at a distance of up to 500 m from the main roads with all weather roads.

Irrigation:

Agriculture is the mainstay of MP's economy. For this, irrigation facility is crucial. The state government has given top priority to this sector. As a result, additional irrigation potential for 13 lakh hectare has been created over last four and half years. A number of incomplete irrigation projects have been completed. Recently the state government has accorded administrative sanction of 432 new projects costing Rs 1236 crore on completion of which irrigation potential for 1.37 lakh hectare would be created. In 2005-06, irrigation potential was created for about 83 thousand at a cost of Rs 813 crore, which was a record in the history of Madhya Pradesh. It was equal to the irrigation potential created during entire 9th Five Year Plan.

- Irrigation potential created for additional 13 lakh hectare.
- A number of incomplete irrigation projects completed. Ban Sagar (Rewa district), Maan (Dhar district), Madikheda (Shivpuri district), Jobat (Jabalpur district), Upper Beda (Khargone district) and many other projects, lying incomplete for many years, completed on a war footing.
- Work on Narmada Valley projects intensified. Till 2003, irrigation potential for only 55 thousand hectare and 90 MW hydel power generation capacity created from Narmada Valley projects, against which irrigation potential for 1.53 lakh hectare had hydel power generation capacity of 2356 MW generated during last four and half years.

A Rs 1919 crore World Bank aided Water Sector Restructuring Project has been taken up in thirty districts for modernization of 158 existing irrigation projects. MP has taken a lead in implementing river linking project by signing an agreement with the central government and Uttar Pradesh government for linking Ken and Betwa rivers. Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan have also agreed to link Parvati, Newaj and Kalisind rivers to Chambal.

The water tax rates have also been rationalized in the state. Earlier, they were based on crop wise irrigation, but now these have been fixed on the basis of water utilization. In 2007-08 a provision of Rs 1255 crore has been made in the budget of 2008-09 for creation of additional irrigation potential for 1.28 lakh hectare. By September 2008, 464 minor irrigation projects will be completed creating additional irrigation potential for 1.05 lakh hectare. Five irrigation projects have been sanctioned in each Assembly constituency and all these 1150 projects would be completed within stipulated period. The maintenance of canals has been handed over to Water Users' Associations and quality control labs have been set up in every district. The powers of Water Users' Associations have been increased and the amount to be given to the committees has been increased from Rs 6 crore to Rs 13.50 crore.

